Clair Smith

FRONTEND ENGINEER · ACCESSIBILITY & PERFORMANCE SPECIALIST

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Portfolio and Writing

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Senior Frontend Developer with 15+ years of experience building complex, content-rich websites and interactive digital experiences. I specialize in JavaScript, modern CSS, accessibility, and founded a Core Web Vitals initiative that became part of ongoing client contracts. I bring a combination of hands-on engineering expertise, design sensibility, and cross-functional collaboration to my work, connecting technical decisions with user experience, product goals, and long-term business value.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages	JavaScript (ES5/ES6) • TypeScript • HTML5 • SASS / SCSS
Frameworks	React • Next.js • Node.js • Gatsby • GraphQL • REST APIs • Twig
Build Tools	Webpack • Vite • NPM
Platforms	Drupal • WordPress • Storybook • Lando • DDEV • Docker
AI Tools	Claude CLI • GitHub Copilot • Chat GPT
Design Tools	Figma • InVision • Sketch • Photoshop • Illustrator
Practices	Accessibility / AQA Testing • WCAG 2.1 / 2.2 • ARIA • Core Web Vitals • Atomic Design • Information Architecture • Content Modeling • Client Discovery • Requirements Extraction • Scope Definition • A/B Testing • Stakeholder Management • Code Review • Git • GitHub • GitLab • Jira • Wrike

EXPERIENCE

Senior Frontend Developer Jan 2024 – Aug 2026

Miles Partnership · Remote

- Served as lead accessibility developer — conducting AQA testing, authoring accessibility tasks, and reviewing PRs across the development team to uphold WCAG standards.
- Founded and drove the company's Core Web Vitals initiative, now embedded in contracts with multiple clients; authored all internal CWV documentation and own ongoing task creation and code review for the program.

- Architected and built new features and components across a portfolio of up to 65 clients, contributing deep JavaScript logic, UI implementation, and system-level architecture decisions.
- Triaged and resolve bugs at scale, maintaining performance and stability across a large, multi-client codebase.

Freelance Development Consultant

Jun 2022 – Jan 2024

Independent · Austin, TX

- Lead customer discovery conversations to surface business goals, uncover technical constraints, and extract precise requirements before scoping new development initiatives.
- Advised on high-impact improvements to existing designs, workflows, and site architecture based on structured requirements extraction and stakeholder input.
- Coordinated tasks and project deliverables with client teams including designers and content creators.
- Designed and built responsive, accessible websites optimized to drive business goals and user engagement.

Frontend Engineer

Dec 2021 – Jun 2022

IfThen · Remote

- Collaborated with backend developers to define and consume well-structured API contracts on the frontend.
- Built component libraries and global style guides aligned to client brand identities, packaged and distributed via NPM for multi-site use.
- Managed stakeholder relationships across client sales, marketing, and engineering teams to align on requirements and deliver scalable, intuitive site architectures and navigation systems.
- Architected React file structures and tooling for deployment in SPAs and static site integrations.

Senior Frontend Developer → Frontend Engineer

Apr 2020 – Nov 2021

Forum One · Remote

- Served as technical lead and primary stakeholder contact on small-to-medium projects — managing client relationships, extracting requirements, and owning delivery from architecture through launch.
- Conducted requirements extraction sessions with clients and managers to design scalable information architectures and detailed content models for components, page types, and site sections.
- Collaborated with design and UX teams to validate technical feasibility of UI/UX designs and translate wireframes into interactive components.
- Built reusable component libraries across multiple frameworks; optimized applications for performance and accessibility (WCAG compliance).
- Mentored junior and associate developers through code reviews, technical instruction, and hands-on training.

Senior Frontend Developer → Project Manager Apr 2016 – Mar 2020

Mediacurrent · Remote

- Built and maintained custom themes across multiple platforms and technology stacks including Drupal, WordPress, React, and Angular.
- Led a team of developers — setting priorities, assigning tasks, providing ticket estimates, and defining acceptance criteria.
- Acted as liaison between project stakeholders, the project manager, and the development team to align technical delivery with business goals.
- Promoted to Project Manager — facilitated cross-functional meetings and planning activities for a globally distributed technology team across multiple time zones.
- Led stakeholder management across executive, technical, and client-facing teams — defining project responsibilities, acceptance criteria, and documentation standards.
- Managed project scope, timeline, and budget allocation for major feature builds while proactively resolving blockers to ensure on-time delivery.

EDUCATION

A.A.S. in Computer and Information Sciences May 2012

Dutchess Community College — New York

Studies in Public Relations, Advertising & Applied Communication 1999 – 2002

The University of Texas at San Antonio